

Gift Card Policy

Policy Purpose and Scope: Gift cards are permitted only for limited discretionary recognition and appreciation by managers at the district level. They serve as a discretionary bonus tool to acknowledge one-off events and individual contributions. Gift cards do not constitute wages or any form of guaranteed or recurring bonus, and their use is strictly controlled to avoid compliance, tax, and fraud risks. The policy applies to all employees, managers, contractors, and departments handling gift cards with company funds.

Permitted Discretionary Uses: Gift cards may be issued at management discretion for occasional recognition for exceeding expectations, one-time team milestones, or appreciation initiatives not tied to performance evaluations or required outcomes.

Prohibited Uses: Gift cards must never substitute for wages, bonuses, commissions, overtime, shift differentials, expense reimbursements, or any payroll/procurement obligation. They may not be tied to KPIs, sales goals, attendance, or required duties, nor used for hardship assistance or to circumvent internal controls.

Controls and Compliance: Advance approval is required through designated channels. Gift cards must be purchased through approved vendors and payment methods. Gift cards are treated as taxable income and must be reported in accordance with payroll and tax reporting requirements.

Exceptions require prior written approval from the **District Controller**.

Improper or unauthorized use of gift cards may result in discipline up to but not limited to revocation of gift card privileges and termination of employment.

Please contact your supervisor or Regional Human Resources with any questions.